Dear Yamauchi-san — About planting kiri (meeting of 22 October)

Thank you for your time today. Here are an expert's views on planting kiri, for reference. They are not our policy, only one opinion. Your thinking comes first.

The expert's views

Sugimoto Kazuya (Sugimoto Forest Management Office, Tenkawa). Personal reply of 15 October. He is happy for me to pass it on to you.

- **Single species:** He does not favour kiri alone, for forest diversity.
- **Mixing:** Mixing with other broadleaves or sugi is fine.
- **Growth:** In Tenkawa kiri comes up on deer-affected clear-cuts. It likes sun, grows fast, and he expects no harm to the soil.
- **Harvest at 5 years:** Not confirmed that all trees grow large. He does not know if harvest is possible.
- **Altitude:** Large trees at ~300 m in sunny spots. Tends to disappear near 1,000 m.
- **Buyers:** Nobody in Nara plants kiri for harvest. He thinks Kinki has no buyer.
- **Lifespan:** A pioneer species; later shade-tolerant trees outcompete it. (His everyday impression, no academic evidence.)
- **Fuel:** He says the wood is too light. Our research: about 6% less energy per kg than sugi. Lower per m³, so more hauling and storage, but usable.

What I would like to ask

- **Exit:** Who would buy at year 5? Do you know a buyer?
- **Deer, bear, frost:** How will you protect the trees?
- **Mixing:** Kiri on part of the land, broadleaves on the rest? What will grow between the kiri after the cut?
- **Ureshino (Mie) mountain:** Already cut? What is growing there? When will kiri be planted?
- **Planting on 26 October:** Time, place, number of trees, area, type of seedlings.

Kiri flowers and what could come next

- **Edible flowers:** Sweet, with a taste and scent of vanilla and honey. A possible new product.
- **No spraying:** Edible use needs no pesticides or chemicals. Do you plan to spray?
- **Planting idea:** Kiri on the south slope, mixed broadleaf forest on the north and other slopes.
- **Tourism idea:** A kiri grove with walking paths, a place to visit in flowering season.
- **Model:** The mitsumata colony in Misugi-cho, Tsu City (Mie), next to Mitsue. Paths, observation deck, gazebo, signs, extra buses in bloom season.

Our basic approach: In Mitsue, native broadleaf trees that wildlife can feed on.

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